pattern from waist to shoulder along waist dart fold line. Overlap darts the desired amount to decrease the bust area. Do not overlap at shoulder seam. (New darts will be smaller than the original darts).

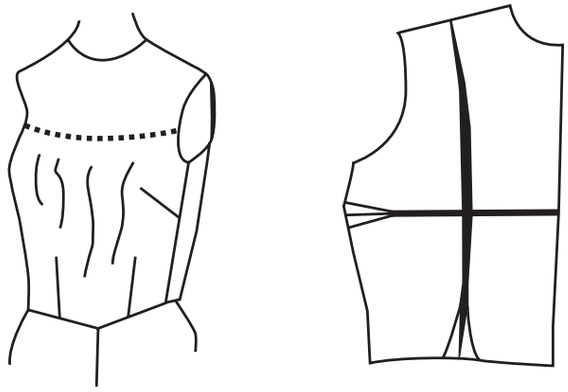


Figure 8.16 Pattern Alteration for Small Bust

Narrow Shoulders

Slash from midpoint of shoulder down and across to middle of armscye. Overlap pattern the desired amount, and redraw. Be sure to complete alterations for both bodice front and back.

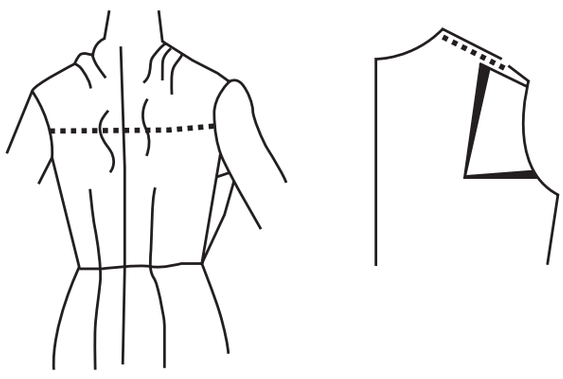


Figure 8.17 Pattern Alteration for Narrow Shoulder

Broad Shoulders

Slash from midpoint of shoulder down and across to the middle of armscye. Spread pattern the desired amount. Redraw seam from neckline to armscye. Be sure to complete alterations for both bodice front and back.

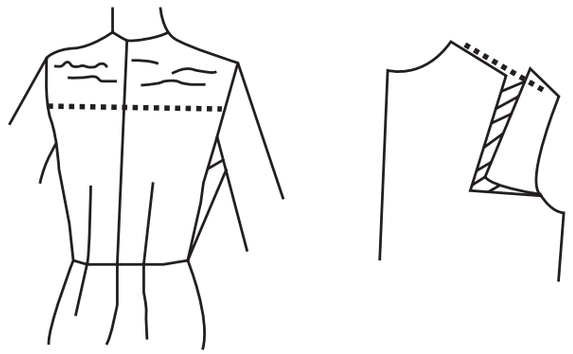


Figure 8.18 Pattern Alteration for Broad Shoulders

8.17.5 Principles of Pattern Alteration

- As far as possible make changes within a pattern by slashing and spreading or slashing and lapping. Patterns can also be altered by redrawing the edges of the pattern. (This is the method adopted for altering garments at the time of fitting.) But the first method is the best in altering paper patterns.
- To preserve the original grain line, make all slashes and folds parallel or perpendicular to the grain line (to centre front line, centre back line etc).
- Where there are darts, make changes between the tip of the dart and the outside edge.
- If an alteration in length is made along one edge of the pattern, take care to make an identical alteration in the adjoining edge. For example, if back shoulder seam is shortened the front shoulder seam should also be shortened.
- When tucks or darts are used for making a pattern smaller, remember that the width of these should be just half the amount to be removed.
- When decreasing or increasing the width of pattern pieces, if only half the pattern (half back or half front) is used, subtract or add only one fourth of the total adjustment to be

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